



CLASH OF CAVALRY

Ordered to ravage the fertile Shenandoah Valley, Union cavalry commander Philip Sheridan rode into Winchester on September 19, 1864, with an army of 39,000—more than double that of the Confederates. In the ensuing battle, Sheridan's three cavalry divisions thundered down Berryville Pike with such force that the Confederates were shattered. A witness recalled: "The enemy's line broke into a thousand fragments under the shock."